WEEK 20 · DIGITAL MARKETING & AI BOOTCAMP

Capstone Project & Certification

The capstone handbook and whole-course revision companion for the DMM & AI certificate

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PART A

The Capstone

What it is, how to choose a business, the 4-week plan, the deliverables and how it is assessed

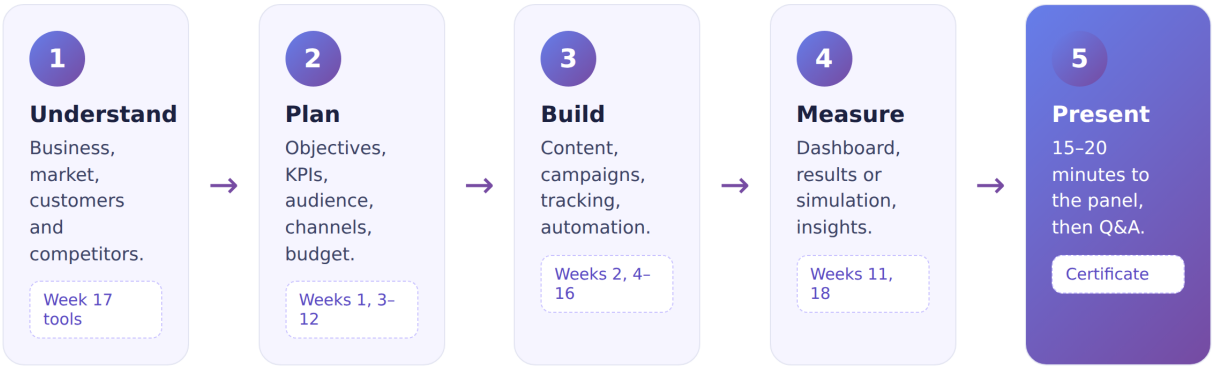
SECTION 1

What the capstone is

The capstone is the final project of the Digital Marketing & AI Bootcamp. You plan, build, measure and present a complete marketing campaign for a real Mauritian business, from strategy to results. It is the moment where nineteen weeks of separate skills become one piece of professional work.

The capstone in one picture

One real Mauritian business, one campaign, from strategy to presentation



Why the programme ends with a capstone

Employers and clients in Mauritius rarely ask "do you know what a CPA is?". They ask "what have you done?". A capstone gives you a concrete answer: a real business, a real problem, a plan you can defend and numbers you can explain. It is also the single biggest piece of your final grade (30%, Section 20) and the centre of your portfolio (Section 21).

The capstone is…	The capstone is not…
One integrated campaign that uses several channels, each with a clear job	Nineteen weekly assignments stapled together
Built for a real business with its permission	A plan for an imaginary company or a famous global brand
Honest about results, including weak ones and simulations	A collection of screenshots that only show good news
A business argument: spend this, expect that, here is why	A list of tools you know how to use
Presented in 15–20 minutes, then defended in Q&A	A 60-slide deck read aloud

What the brief asks for

In the words of the programme: **an end-to-end marketing campaign from strategy through execution, analytics and presentation, on a real Mauritian business**. The final deliverable is the **Full Strategy Presentation**; passing the programme earns the **DMM & AI Certificate**.

The tools you are expected to use

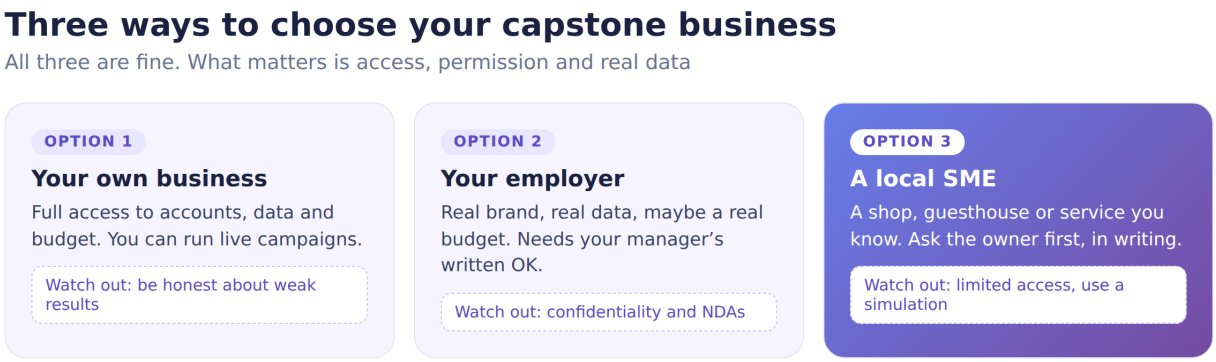
Tool	What it does in your capstone	Week
GA4 (Google Analytics 4)	Measures visits, engagement and key events on the website	2, 11
GTM (Google Tag Manager)	Installs and manages the tags: Google tag, events, Meta Pixel	2, 11
Google Ads	Search (and possibly Performance Max or Demand Gen) campaigns	6, 7, 9
Meta Ads	Facebook and Instagram campaigns, lead forms, click-to-WhatsApp	8
Data Studio	The dashboard that brings all KPIs together	2, 11, 18
Canva	Ad creative, social posts, the presentation itself	4, 5, 13
AI tools	ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini for research and copy; image and video AI; Zapier or Make for automation	13–15

Tip: if a tool does not fit your business (for example Google Ads for a business nobody searches for), you can leave it out, but you must explain why in your channel strategy. A good reason earns marks; silence loses them.

SECTION 2

Choosing your capstone business

The business you choose decides how easy the next four weeks will be. Choose for access and data, not for glamour. A small cake shop where you can see every number beats a big hotel group that will not share anything.



Five tests for a good capstone business

Test	Ask yourself	Good sign
Permission	Will the owner or manager agree in writing?	A short email or WhatsApp message saying yes
Access	Can I see the website, social pages, ad accounts, sales numbers?	Admin or analyst access, or exports shared weekly
A real goal	Does the business want something specific?	"More weekday bookings", "more corporate leads"
A website or landing page	Is there somewhere to send traffic and track key events?	A site with GA4, or one you can add a page to
Your interest	Will I still care about this business in week 4?	You know its customers and its market

Good capstone businesses in Mauritius

- **Hospitality:** a guesthouse in Trou aux Biches, a table d'hôte in Rodrigues, a restaurant in Port Louis, a boat-trip operator in Grand Baie.
- **Retail and e-commerce:** a jewellery brand that sells on Instagram and at markets, a bakery with a delivery service, a bookshop.
- **Services:** a driving school, a physiotherapy clinic, an accountant, a solar installer, a wedding photographer.
- **Education and training:** a language school, tuition centre, gym or dance studio.
- **Non-profits:** an NGO recruiting volunteers or donors (the objective becomes sign-ups or donations instead of sales).

> **Avoid:** businesses in sensitive or restricted areas (gambling, alcohol, medicines, weight loss, financial products, politics). Ad platforms have special rules for them and you will lose weeks on policy problems. Also avoid a business that is about to close, rebrand or change owner.

Your proposal in one page

Before you start, you submit a capstone proposal (Exercise 20.1, Section 29): the business, your access, the business goal, a first SMART objective, the channels you expect to use, the budget (real or simulated) and the risks. Your trainers confirm it or ask for changes. Do not build anything before the proposal is confirmed.

SECTION 3

Ethics, consent and confidentiality

You will see information that belongs to someone else: sales figures, customer lists, ad accounts, maybe plans that competitors would love to know. Treat it as a professional would. This section is not optional; breaking these rules can fail a capstone.

Permission in writing

Ask the owner or your manager for written permission before you start. A simple message is enough. Keep it in your capstone folder.

```
Hello Mrs Ramsamy,
As part of my Digital Marketing & AI training (Oreegami), I would like to use
Lagon Bleu as my final project. I will prepare a marketing plan, set up
tracking and, if you agree, run a small campaign with a budget you approve.
I will present the work to my trainers and classmates. I will not share
customer names, contact details or private figures, and I can anonymise
the business name if you prefer.
May I go ahead? Thank you!
```

The rules

Rule	What it means in practice
No real customer personal data	Never put names, phone numbers, emails, addresses or photos of customers in your deck, documents or dashboard. Use totals, percentages and fictional examples. The Data Protection Act 2017 applies to you as much as to the business.
Respect NDAs and confidentiality	If your employer has a non-disclosure agreement (NDA) or confidentiality policy, follow it. Ask what you may show. If needed, index the numbers (January = 100) or show percentages instead of rupees.
Anonymise when asked	You can call the business "a boutique hotel in the north" and change the logo. The work is still marked fully.
Spend only approved money	Never launch an ad or change a budget without the owner's OK. Record the approval (date, amount, platform).
Use your own logins	Ask to be added as a user (Meta business portfolio, Google Ads, GA4) instead of using the owner's password. Remove your access at the end if asked.
Be honest about AI	Say where you used AI. Check every AI fact and number. Do not present AI-generated reviews or photos as real (Weeks 13–14).
Do not contact customers without consent	Email or WhatsApp only people who opted in (Week 10). No buying lists.

In Mauritius: the Data Protection Office (dataprotection.govmu.org) publishes guidance on the Data Protection Act 2017. If your capstone collects leads through a form, the form needs a short privacy notice that says who collects the data, why, and how to ask for it to be deleted.

Live results, limited results and simulations

Not every business can give you a budget or a month of live data. That is acceptable. You may present **forecasts and simulations**, as long as they are **clearly labelled** and the assumptions are written down (Section 19). What is never acceptable is inventing results and presenting them as real.

SECTION 4

Scope and the 4-week plan

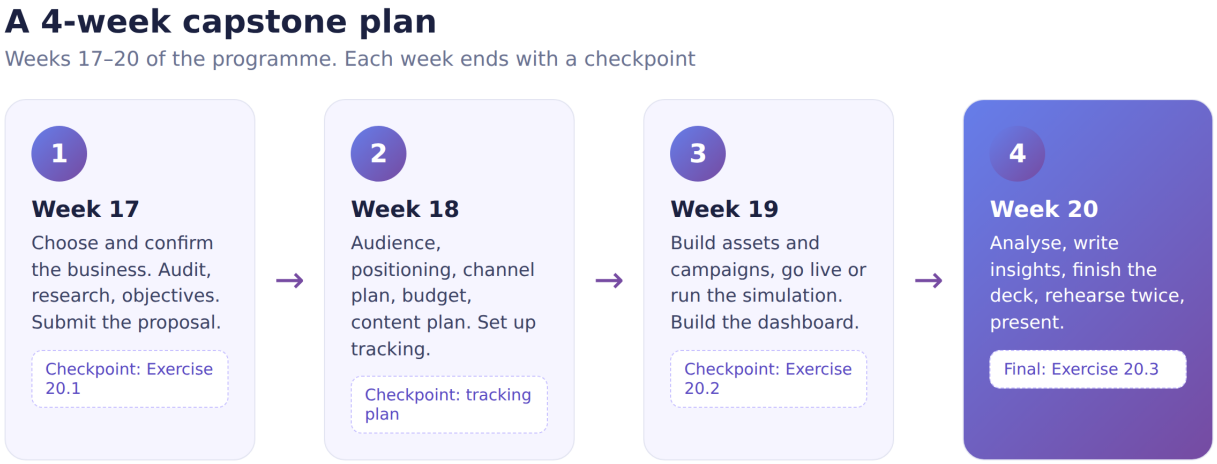
A capstone fails more often from trying to do too much than from doing too little. Pick one business objective, one main audience, one campaign period and the 3–4 channels that matter most for that objective.

Setting the scope

Element	Good scope	Too big
Objective	Increase weekday direct bookings in the low season	"Grow the brand and increase sales and followers"
Audience	Mauritian couples aged 28–45 for weekend breaks, plus one secondary audience	Everyone in Mauritius and all tourists
Channels	Google Search, Meta (Instagram + Facebook), email and Google Business Profile	Every channel from SEO to TikTok to LinkedIn to radio
Period	A 4–6 week campaign, with a 12-month view in the strategy	A full year of activity, executed in detail
Budget	A realistic monthly figure the owner would approve, e.g. Rs 25,000	No budget, or a budget the business could never afford

The 4-week plan

The plan below fits the capstone into the last weeks of the programme, alongside Weeks 17–19. Starting early helps: many students choose their business and request access as soon as the proposal opens.



Week	Main tasks	Checkpoint
1 (programme Week 17)	Permission and access. Business, market and competitor analysis (Section 8). Objectives and KPIs (Section 9). One-page proposal.	Exercise 20.1 submitted and confirmed
2 (Week 18)	Audience and positioning (Section 10), channel plan and budget (Section 11), content plan (Section 12). Tracking plan and setup (Section 14).	Tracking tested; first creative drafts

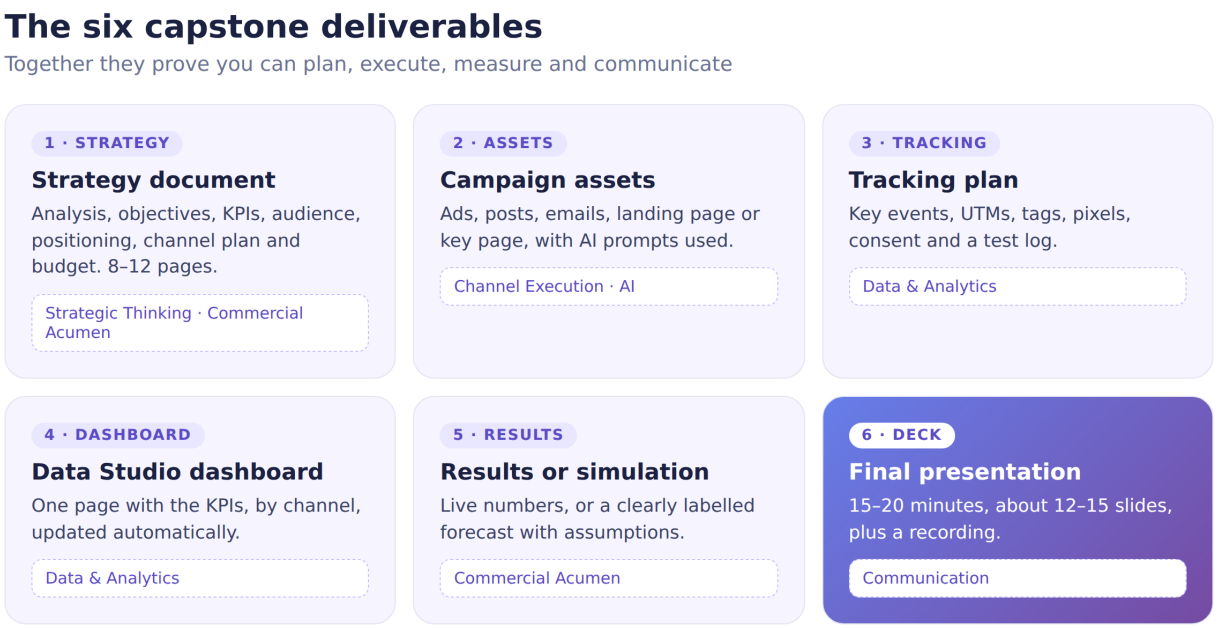
Week	Main tasks	Checkpoint
3 (Week 19)	Build campaigns and assets (Section 13). Go live (small budget) or run the simulation. Automations (Section 15). Build the dashboard.	Exercise 20.2: mid-point review, tracking and dashboard
4 (Week 20)	Analyse results, write insights and the next 90 days (Section 17). Build and rehearse the deck (Sections 18–19). Present.	Exercise 20.3: deck and recording

Tip: if you run live ads, launch by the start of the third week at the latest. Most platforms need several days to stabilise (the Meta learning phase, Google's bid strategy learning), and you want at least 10–14 days of data to analyse.

SECTION 5

The six deliverables

Your capstone is a package, not only a deck. Each deliverable shows a different competency. Keep all of them in one shared folder (Google Drive or similar) with clear file names.



What each deliverable must contain

Deliverable	Must contain	Format and length
1. Strategy document	Business and market analysis, SWOT, objectives and KPIs, audience and personas, positioning, channel plan with roles, budget split, timeline, risks	Google Doc or PDF, 8–12 pages
2. Campaign assets	At least: 3 ad variations per main channel, 4–6 organic posts, 1 email (if relevant), the landing page or key web page (or a wireframe), the AI prompts used	Folder of files, or a Canva link, plus a one-page index
3. Tracking plan	Key events and their definitions, UTM convention, tag list (GTM), Pixel or Conversions API status, consent, test log with dates and results	Google Sheet, 1–3 tabs
4. Dashboard	One Data Studio page with the main KPIs, a trend, a breakdown by channel and a date filter; a short "how to read" note	Data Studio link (view access)
5. Results or simulation	Live results with spend, CPA or ROAS, or a labelled forecast with assumptions and scenarios; your insights	Sheet plus 1–2 pages of commentary
6. Final presentation	12–15 slides presented in 15–20 minutes, then Q&A; a recording of your rehearsal or the live session	Slides (Canva, Google Slides or PowerPoint) + video link

Folder structure

```
Capstone_LagonBleu_YourName/
  00_Proposal_and_permission/
  01_Strategy_document.pdf
  02_Assets/  (ads, posts, email, landing page, prompts.txt)
  03_Tracking_plan (Google Sheet)
  04_Dashboard_link.txt
  05_Results_or_simulation (Sheet + commentary)
  06_Presentation.pdf  +  recording link
```

SECTION 6

How the capstone is assessed

Your capstone is assessed against the six competency areas of the programme. For each area, your trainers look for evidence in your deliverables and presentation, and place you on one of four levels.

The six competency areas

Your capstone and your whole certificate are judged against these

01
Strategic Thinking
Objectives that serve the business, a clear strategy, sensible choices.
Is the plan logical?

02
Channel Execution
Campaigns, SEO, social and email set up correctly and optimised.
Would it work if launched?

03
Data & Analytics
GA4, tags, dashboards, attribution, decisions based on data.
Can we trust the numbers?

04
AI & Automation
AI tools and automations used safely to save time and scale.
Is AI used well and checked?

05
Communication
Clear documents, a strong story, confident presentation and Q&A.
Would a client understand?

06
Commercial Acumen
Budget, ROI, break-even, business impact, stakeholder needs.
Does it make money?

The rubric

Read the table as a ladder. "Proficient" is the professional standard a client would expect from a junior marketer. "Advanced" means the work would impress an agency.

Competency	Beginning	Developing	Proficient	Advanced
Strategic Thinking	Goals are vague; channels chosen by habit	SMART objective, but weak link to the business goal	Clear chain: business goal → objective → KPIs → channels → budget	Also weighs options, risks and trade-offs; 12-month view
Channel Execution	Campaigns described, not built	Built, with setup errors (targeting, tracking, naming)	Correctly built and launched or ready to launch; good structure	Optimised with tests, negatives, audiences and clear next steps
Data & Analytics	No tracking or numbers without sources	Some key events; dashboard incomplete	Tested key events, UTMs, working dashboard, correct metrics	Also explains attribution limits and data quality; uses explorations
AI & Automation	No AI, or AI output pasted unchecked	AI used for copy only, little checking	AI used across research, creative and analysis, checked and disclosed; one automation	AI workflow with human approvals, measured time or cost saving
Communication	Deck is text-heavy; overruns time	Clear slides but no story; weak Q&A	Clear story, every chart has a message, on time, confident Q&A	Persuasive and concise; handles tough questions with data
Commercial Acumen	No budget logic or ROI	Budget given but not justified	Budget justified with break-even CPA or ROAS and expected return	Scenarios, LTV, sensitivity, clear business case

> **How the levels become a mark:** your trainers convert the levels into the capstone mark and confirm the exact weighting of each competency when the capstone opens. The capstone counts for 30% of your final grade (Section 20). The pass mark for the certificate is confirmed by your trainers.

Where the evidence comes from

Competency	Main evidence
Strategic Thinking	Strategy document (analysis, objectives, channel roles), slides 3–7
Channel Execution	Campaign assets, screenshots of builds, settings, slides 8–9
Data & Analytics	Tracking plan, test log, dashboard, slide 10 and 12
AI & Automation	Prompts, AI-assisted assets, automation evidence, slide 11
Communication	The deck, the recording, the Q&A
Commercial Acumen	Budget, break-even, results or forecast, slides 7, 12, 13

SECTION 7

Common capstone mistakes

Trainers see the same mistakes in every cohort. Read this list now, and again before you present.

Mistake	Why it hurts	Fix
Starting with tools ("I will do TikTok and Google Ads")	Channels must follow the objective and audience, not the other way round	Write the objective and audience first (Sections 9–10)
Objectives that cannot be measured	You cannot prove success or failure	SMART objective with a number and a date; one north-star KPI
Tracking set up last	Campaign runs without data; results are guesses	Tracking in week 2, tested before any spend (Section 14)
Too many channels, too little budget	Rs 15,000 split over six channels teaches nothing	2–3 paid channels maximum for a small budget
Vanity metrics	Likes and followers do not pay salaries	Lead with business KPIs: leads, bookings, CPA, ROAS, revenue
Copying templates without adapting	Panel sees generic work	Use the business's real prices, places, language and customers
AI output not checked	Wrong facts, wrong prices, wrong tone	Human review of every AI asset; note what you changed
Hiding weak results	Destroys trust in the rest of the work	Show them, explain why, show what you learned and would change
A deck with 40 slides	You run out of time and lose the story	12–15 slides; detail goes in the appendix
Reading the slides	The panel reads faster than you speak	One idea per slide, you tell the story
No recommendation at the end	The panel asks "so what?"	Finish with the next 90 days and a clear ask
Personal data in screenshots	Breaks the Data Protection Act and the rules	Blur or crop names, emails and phone numbers

PART B

Build the Capstone

Ten steps from analysis to insights, each with a checklist and a template

SECTION 8

Step 1: business and market analysis

Everything starts with understanding the business and its market. This step reuses the strategy tools from Week 17 and the audits from Weeks 1–5. The goal is a short, sharp diagnosis, not a long description.

What to analyse

Area	Questions	Tools and sources
The business	What does it sell, at what prices and margins? Who buys? When? What is the business goal this year?	Interview with the owner, sales data, price list
Digital presence	Website speed and conversion path, GA4, Google Business Profile, social pages, reviews, email list	PageSpeed Insights, GA4, Search Console, Meta Business Suite (Weeks 2–5)
Market	Size, seasons, trends, local events, tourism flows, economic context	Statistics Mauritius, Google Trends, PESTLE (Week 17)
Competitors	3–5 direct competitors: offer, prices, channels, ads, reviews, tone	Meta Ad Library, Google Ads Transparency Center, Google search, Maps
Customers	Who they are, why they buy, what stops them, which words they use	Reviews, DMs, sales staff, a short survey, AI review analysis (Week 13)

Summarise in a SWOT

A SWOT lists internal **Strengths** and **Weaknesses**, and external **Opportunities** and **Threats**. Keep 3–4 points per box, each specific and backed by a fact.

Strengths (internal)	Weaknesses (internal)
4.8 stars from 210 Google reviews; beach access; owner speaks EN/FR/DE	Website loads in 6 s on mobile; no GA4 key events; 70% of bookings via OTAs (online travel agencies)
Opportunities (external)	**Threats (external)**
Local weekend-break demand in winter; more people search "staycation Mauritius"	New guesthouses in the area; OTA commissions; rising ad costs in peak season

Lagon Bleu guesthouse, Trou aux Biches: fictional example.

Checklist

- ☐ Owner interview done (goal, margins, seasons, capacity, budget)
- ☐ Website, GA4, Search Console, Google Business Profile and social pages audited
- ☐ 3–5 competitors compared on offer, price, channels and ads
- ☐ Customer insight from reviews and messages (top 5 reasons to buy, top 5 objections)
- ☐ SWOT with facts, and one sentence: "The main problem / opportunity is…"

SECTION 9

Step 2: objectives and KPIs

Your objective links the business goal to marketing. Week 1 taught SMART objectives and KPIs; Week 17 added the cascade from business goal to channel KPI. In the capstone, the panel checks that every number you show traces back to this page.

From business goal to KPIs

Level	Example (Lagon Bleu)
Business goal	Raise weekday occupancy from 45% to 60% in June–August
Marketing objective (SMART)	Generate 60 direct weekday bookings from Mauritian residents between 1 June and 31 August, at a cost per booking under Rs 900
North-star KPI	Direct weekday bookings (key event: booking_confirmed)
Supporting KPIs	Cost per booking (CPA), booking conversion rate, WhatsApp enquiries, ROAS
Channel KPIs	Search: CTR, CPC, impression share. Meta: CPM, CTR, cost per conversation. Email: click rate

Set targets with maths, not hope

Work backwards from the objective (Week 12). If a booking is worth on average Rs 7,200 (two nights) with a 45% contribution margin, the most you can pay for one booking and still break even is Rs 7,200 × 0.45 = **Rs 3,240**. A target CPA of Rs 900 leaves plenty of profit and room to learn. With a conversion rate of 3% from ad click to booking, 60 bookings need about 2,000 clicks; at a CPC of Rs 12 that is about Rs 24,000 of media.

Item	Formula	Result
Maximum (break-even) CPA	Average booking value × contribution margin	Rs 7,200 × 0.45 = Rs 3,240
Clicks needed	Bookings ÷ conversion rate	60 ÷ 0.03 = 2,000
Media budget	Clicks × CPC	2,000 × Rs 12 = Rs 24,000
Expected CPA	Budget ÷ bookings	Rs 24,000 ÷ 60 = Rs 400
Expected ROAS	Revenue ÷ ad spend	(60 × Rs 7,200) ÷ Rs 24,000 = 18

Illustrative numbers. A guesthouse with high value per booking can show a very high ROAS; a cake shop will not.

Checklist

- ☐ One business goal, one SMART marketing objective, one north-star KPI
- ☐ Break-even CPA or ROAS calculated (Section 26)
- ☐ Targets for 3–5 supporting KPIs, each with a source
- ☐ Every KPI is something you can actually measure with your tracking

SECTION 10

Step 3: audience and positioning

Who exactly are you talking to, and why should they choose this business over the others? Weeks 4 and 5 covered personas and voice; Week 8 showed how audiences become targeting.

Persona template

Field	Example: "Weekend Staycation Couple"
Who	Couple, 28–45, living in Curepipe, Quatre Bornes or Port Louis, both working
Need	A short break without flying; somewhere calm by the sea; good food
Triggers	Anniversary, public holiday, school holidays, payday weekend
Objections	"Too expensive for locals", "only for tourists", "far from home"
Where they are	Instagram, Facebook, Google Maps, WhatsApp; search "weekend getaway Mauritius", "hotel promo resident"
Language	English and French in ads; Kreol in comments and WhatsApp
What makes them act	Resident offer, clear price per night, real photos, quick WhatsApp answer

The positioning statement

Write one sentence that the whole campaign will repeat:

> **For** [audience] **who** [need], **[brand]** is the [category] **that** [main benefit], **because** [proof].
>
> *For Mauritian couples who want a short, calm break by the sea, Lagon Bleu is the family guesthouse in Trou aux Biches that feels like a holiday 45 minutes from home, because it has direct beach access, a resident price and 4.8 stars from 210 guests.*

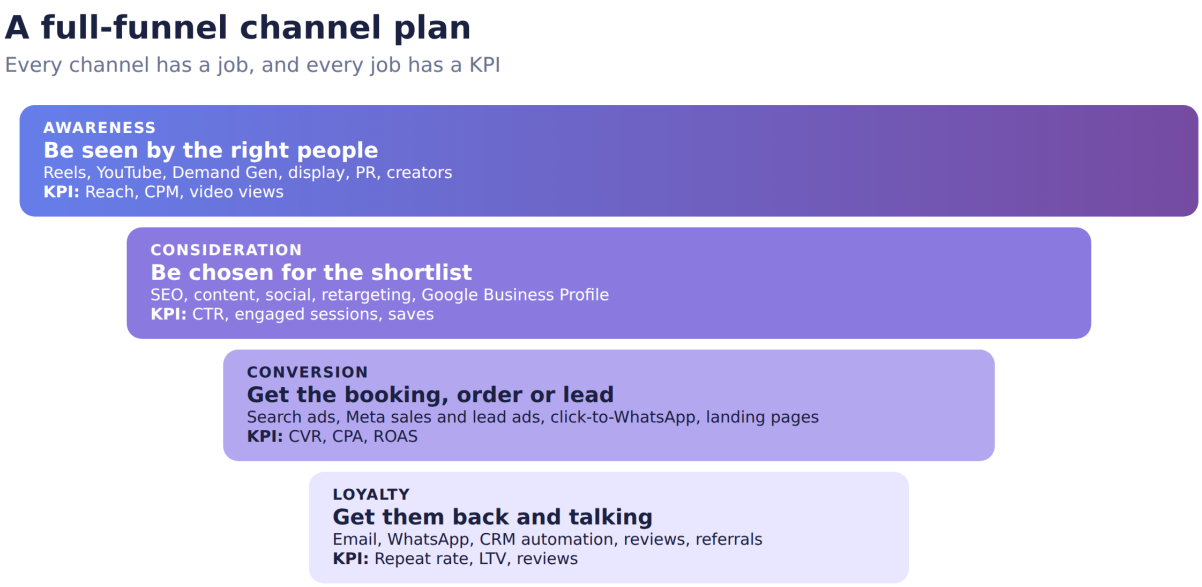
Checklist

- ☐ 1 primary persona (and at most 1 secondary)
- ☐ Objections listed with an answer for each
- ☐ Positioning statement with proof
- ☐ Key message and 3 supporting messages
- ☐ Tone of voice and languages decided

SECTION 11

Step 4: channel strategy and budget

Each channel must have a job in the funnel and a KPI. Weeks 3–10 taught the channels one by one; Week 12 taught how to split money between them. Now you combine them.



Channel roles template

Channel	Funnel role	What you will do	KPI	Budget/month
Google Search	Conversion	1 campaign, 2 ad groups (staycation, couples offer), exact and phrase match, sitelinks	CPA, CVR	Rs 10,000
Meta (FB + IG)	Awareness → conversion	Reels and carousel for residents; retargeting; click-to-WhatsApp	Cost per conversation, CPA	Rs 12,000
Google Business Profile	Consideration	Weekly posts, offer, photos, answer every review	Calls, direction requests	Rs 0
Email + WhatsApp	Loyalty	Past-guest offer, 3-email sequence, broadcast to opted-in contacts	Click rate, bookings	Rs 0 (free tier)
SEO / content	Consideration (long term)	One landing page "Staycation in Trou aux Biches", FAQ for AI answers	Organic sessions, rankings	Rs 0
Creative and tools	All	Canva Pro, AI images, a short shoot with a phone	-	Rs 3,000

Budget rules for a small capstone

- **Concentrate.** With under Rs 30,000 a month, use 2 paid channels at most. Each needs enough budget to get out of learning (Week 8: about 50 optimisation events in 7 days for a Meta ad set; choose a lighter event if needed).

- **Use 70/20/10** (Week 12): about 70% on what is proven, 20% on promising ideas, 10% on experiments.
- **Keep a reserve.** Hold back 10–15% to move to the winner after the first week.
- **Count all costs.** Media, tools, creative production and your time. Commercial acumen means total cost, not only ad spend.
- **Watch seasonality.** Ad costs rise in busy periods (end of year, festivals) and demand changes with tourist seasons and school holidays.

Checklist

☐ Every channel has a funnel role, actions, a KPI and a budget

☐ Total budget approved by the owner (or labelled as simulated)

☐ Budget is enough to reach the targets in Section 9

☐ Reason given for each channel left out

SECTION 12

Step 5: content and creative plan

Content carries your positioning to the audience. Use the pillars, formats and calendar from Week 4, the platform playbooks from Week 5 and the AI creative workflow from Weeks 13–14.

Creative matrix

Plan creative as a matrix: messages (rows) × formats (columns). This forces variety and makes testing easy.

Message	Reel 9:16 (15–30 s)	Carousel 4:5	Search ad (RSA)	Email
"A holiday 45 minutes from home"	Arrival, sea, dinner in 3 shots	5 reasons to book a weekend	Headline: Weekend Escape by the Sea	Subject: Your weekend by the sea?
"Resident price"	Owner talks to camera (FR/Kreol)	Price per night, what is included	Headline: Resident Rate from Rs 3,600	Past-guest offer
"Trusted by 210 guests"	Guest-style b-roll, no real names	Review quotes (with permission)	Asset: 4.8 stars, sitelink Reviews	Social proof block

Creative rules

- **Hook in the first 2 seconds** of video; show the product or place early (ABCD from Week 9).
- **Design for mobile** and sound-off: captions on every video.
- **Real beats perfect.** Real photos of the place, the team and the product usually outperform stock images.
- **AI with care:** AI can draft scripts, captions and variations, extend backgrounds or resize. Never invent rooms, dishes or products that do not exist, and follow platform AI labels (Week 14).
- **One call to action** per piece: Book now, Send a WhatsApp, Get the offer.

Checklist

☐ Content calendar for the campaign period (posts, ads, emails)

☐ At least 3 creative variations per paid channel

☐ Copy checked for prices, dates, spelling, EN/FR consistency

☐ Rights: you own or have permission for every photo, music track and review quote

SECTION 13

Step 6: campaign build

Now you build what you planned. The step-by-step setups are in the Week 6–10 guides; here is what the panel checks.

Platform	Build checklist	Week
Google Ads Search	Correct goal and key event; location "Mauritius, presence"; languages; tight ad groups; 15 headlines and 4 descriptions per RSA where possible; sitelinks, callouts, call asset; negative keywords; a bid strategy that matches your data (Maximise clicks or conversions to start, tCPA later)	6, 7
Performance Max / Demand Gen	Only with working conversion tracking and enough budget; good assets and audience signals; brand exclusions where relevant	6, 9, 14
Meta Ads	Right objective (Sales, Leads, Engagement for messaging); Pixel and Conversions API tested; Advantage+ audience or a clear reason not to; placements; 3–6 ads per ad set; UTM tags; naming convention	8
Click-to-WhatsApp / lead forms	Welcome message and quick replies; instant form with a qualifying question and privacy policy link; someone answers fast	8, 15
Email	Opt-in list only; SPF, DKIM, DMARC on the sending domain; mobile test; UTM on every link	10
Landing page	Message match with the ad; fast on mobile; one main CTA; WhatsApp and phone; trust (reviews, photos); key events tracked	2, 16

Naming convention

Use one naming pattern across platforms so your dashboard can group results. Example:

```
Campaign:  LB_2026-06_Search_Conv_Staycation
Ad set:    LB_META_Conv_Residents_25-45_Advplus
Ad:        LB_Reel_Price_FR_v2
UTM:       utm_source=facebook&utm_medium=paid_social&utm_campaign=lb_2026-06_staycation
```

Checklist

- ☐ Every campaign has the right objective and is optimised for the right key event
- ☐ Budgets and dates match the approved plan
- ☐ Ads approved; no policy warnings
- ☐ Screenshots of the build saved (they become evidence in your deck)
- ☐ A launch log: date, change, reason

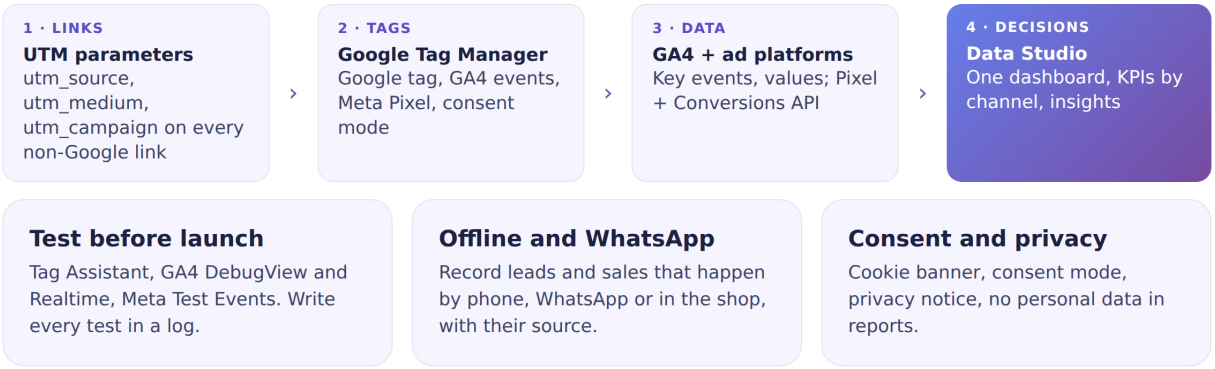
SECTION 14

Step 7: tracking and measurement

If it is not tracked, it did not happen. Week 2 set up GA4 and GTM; Week 11 added the measurement plan, custom events and Data Studio; Week 12 added values, enhanced conversions and the Conversions API. In the capstone you prove your numbers can be trusted.

The measurement stack for your capstone

From a click on an ad to a number on your dashboard



The tracking plan template

Key event	Definition (when it fires)	Tool and trigger	Value	Tested on
booking_confirmed	Thank-you page after a paid booking	GTM: page view, URL contains /merci	Booking value	3 June: OK in DebugView
whatsapp_click	Click on any wa.me link	GTM: click URL contains wa.me	Rs 500 (estimated lead value)	3 June: OK
generate_lead	Contact form submitted	GTM: form submission or thank-you page	Rs 500	4 June: OK
Lead (Meta)	Instant form submitted	Meta automatic	-	Test lead via Lead Ads Testing Tool

Measurement rules

- **Mark the important events as key events** in GA4 and import or link them into Google Ads.
- **UTM every link** that is not auto-tagged: social posts, emails, WhatsApp broadcasts, QR codes. Use lower case and one convention.
- **Test before spending:** Tag Assistant, GA4 DebugView and Realtime, Meta Events Manager test events. Write the result in the test log.
- **Capture offline results.** Bookings by phone or WhatsApp: ask "how did you hear about us?" and record the source in a sheet or CRM.
- **Know why numbers differ.** Google Ads, Meta and GA4 count with different attribution models and windows; your dashboard should say which source each number comes from (Week 11).
- **Respect consent:** cookie banner and consent mode where needed; no personal data in GA4 or in the dashboard.

The dashboard

One page in Data Studio: a scorecard row (spend, key events, CPA, ROAS or revenue, conversion rate), a trend over time, a table by channel or campaign, and a date control. Add a short text box: "What this dashboard shows and where the data comes from". Share it with view access.

Checklist

- ☐ Tracking plan written
- ☐ Every key event tested and logged
- ☐ UTM convention applied everywhere
- ☐ Dashboard connected to GA4 (and ads data via a sheet or connector)
- ☐ Data sources noted on the dashboard

SECTION 15

Step 8: AI and automation

AI and automation are one of the six competencies. The panel wants to see that you used AI where it helps, checked it, and built at least one simple automation that saves time or speeds up a lead response (Weeks 13–15).

Where	Good use of AI	Evidence to show
Research	Summarise 200 reviews into themes; draft a competitor table; build personas from real data	Prompt + output + what you corrected
Creative	Headline and caption variations; scripts; image edits and resizes; translations EN/FR/Kreol checked by a human	Prompt library, before/after
Ad platforms	Smart Bidding, Performance Max, AI Max, Advantage+ steered with good inputs	Settings, assets, exclusions
Analysis	Explain a drop in CVR; suggest tests; write a first draft of insights	Prompt + your final judgement
Automation	Meta lead to Google Sheet + CRM + WhatsApp alert; review alert; weekly report email	Zapier/Make screenshots, a successful test run

Prompt template (C.A.R.E. from Week 13)

```
Context: I market Lagon Bleu, a 12-room family guesthouse in Trou aux Biches.
         Audience: Mauritian couples 28-45. Tone: warm, simple, FR and EN.
Action:  Write 10 headlines (max 30 characters) for a Google search ad
         promoting the resident weekend rate from Rs 3,600 per night.
Result:  A table: headline | character count | angle (price, place, proof).
Example: "Weekend by the Sea" (18).
```

AI rules for the capstone: never paste customer personal data into an AI tool; check every fact, price and claim; disclose AI-generated images where platforms require it; keep a record of the prompts you used. Measure the benefit: "AI cut caption writing from 3 hours to 45 minutes a week".

Checklist

- ☐ AI used in at least 3 steps, with prompts saved
- ☐ Human check documented
- ☐ One automation built and tested
- ☐ Time or cost saving estimated

SECTION 16

Step 9: e-commerce and CRO (if relevant)

If your business sells online or takes bookings on its website, conversion rate optimisation (CRO) can be worth more than extra ad budget. Week 16 covered e-commerce and advanced conversion strategies; use what fits.

Quick CRO audit

Step of the journey	Check	Typical fix
Landing	Does the page match the ad message? Loads fast on mobile?	Dedicated landing page; compress images
Product / offer	Clear price, photos, what is included, delivery or check-in details?	Price and fees visible early; FAQ
Trust	Reviews, guarantees, secure payment, real contact details?	Review widget; WhatsApp button; return policy
Cart / booking	How many steps? Forced account creation?	Guest checkout; fewer form fields; local payment options
After purchase	Confirmation, thank-you page, follow-up?	Thank-you page with key event; review request; cross-sell email

E-commerce numbers to report

- **Conversion rate** = orders ÷ sessions × 100.
- **AOV (average order value)** = revenue ÷ orders.
- **Cart abandonment rate** = 1 − (completed purchases ÷ carts created). Across many studies it averages around 70%, so a recovery email or WhatsApp reminder to opted-in customers is worth testing.
- **Revenue per session** = revenue ÷ sessions = conversion rate × AOV. It combines both levers in one number.
- **Repeat purchase rate** and **LTV** (Section 26) for businesses that sell again to the same customers.

If your business is not e-commerce, apply the same thinking to the lead form or the WhatsApp conversation: count each step and fix the biggest drop first.

Checklist

☐ Funnel steps counted in GA4 (funnel exploration, Week 11)

☐ Biggest drop identified

☐ One CRO change proposed or tested, with the expected effect

SECTION 17

Step 10: reporting and insights

Data is not the deliverable; decisions are. Week 18 covered performance reporting and data storytelling. Your capstone report turns numbers into three to five insights and a plan.

Results table template

KPI	Target	Actual / forecast	Status	Comment
Spend	Rs 22,000	Rs 21,450	On track	2 weeks live
Bookings (direct, weekday)	20 (pro rata)	14	Below	Search strong, Meta weak
CPA	Under Rs 900	Rs 1,532	Below	Meta CPA Rs 2,900; Search Rs 780
WhatsApp conversations	80	126	Above	Click-to-WhatsApp works; slow replies at weekends
ROAS	8	4.7	Below	Still above break-even 2.2

Fictional example. The break-even ROAS of 2.2 is 1 ÷ 0.45 contribution margin, rounded.

Writing an insight

An insight has three parts (Section 19): **what** happened (with a number), **so what** (why it matters), **now what** (the decision).

> **Example insight:** WhatsApp conversations were 58% above target, but only 1 in 9 became a booking, compared with 1 in 4 on weekdays. Messages sent on Saturday waited 5 hours for a reply on average. **Recommendation:** set up quick replies and an away message, and assign weekend cover; if the weekend conversion matches weekdays, we expect around 6 extra bookings a month.

Checklist

- ☐ Results vs targets table with sources
- ☐ 3–5 insights in what / so what / now what form
- ☐ Recommendations with expected impact
- ☐ Next 90 days plan
- ☐ Limits of the data stated (short period, small numbers, attribution)

PART C

Present Your Work

The 15–20 minute presentation,
data storytelling, rehearsal
and questions from the panel

SECTION 18

The presentation, slide by slide

Your Full Strategy Presentation lasts 15–20 minutes, followed by questions. Think of the panel as the business owner and their finance manager: busy, curious, and focused on what the money will do.

The 14-slide capstone deck

About 1–1.5 minutes per slide: 15–20 minutes in total



Highlighted slides are the ones the panel remembers: the summary, the results and what you would do next.

Slide-by-slide template

Fourteen slides in about 17 minutes leaves a margin for a slow start or a technical problem. Put extra detail (full keyword list, all creatives, full tracking plan) in an appendix after slide 14.

#	Slide	What to put on it	Time
1	Title	Business (or anonymised name), your name, date, one-line promise: "60 weekday bookings in a quiet season"	0:20
2	Executive summary	The problem, what you did, the main result and the recommendation, in 3–4 lines	1:00
3	The business	What it sells, to whom, key numbers (prices, capacity, channels), the business goal	1:00
4	Market and competitors	SWOT or a competitor table; the one opportunity you chose	1:30
5	Objectives and KPIs	SMART objective, north-star KPI, targets and break-even	1:00
6	Audience and positioning	Persona card, positioning statement, key message	1:00
7	Channel plan and budget	Funnel diagram with channel roles; budget split and why	1:30
8	Creative and content	3–4 best assets on screen, the test plan	1:30
9	Campaign build	Structure, targeting and settings (screenshots, cropped and anonymised)	1:00
10	Tracking and dashboard	Key events, test log result, dashboard screenshot	1:00
11	AI and automation	Where AI helped, the automation flow, time saved	1:00
12	Results or forecast	Results vs targets table or labelled forecast; one chart	2:00
13	Insights and next 90 days	3 insights (what, so what, now what); 90-day plan and budget	2:00

#	Slide	What to put on it	Time
14	Close and ask	Summary in one sentence; what you ask the owner to approve	0:30

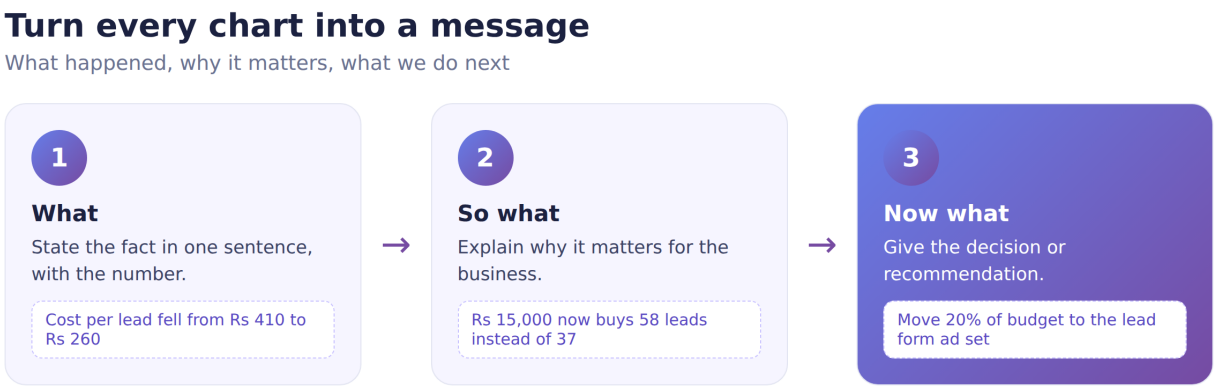
Design rules

- **One message per slide**, written as the slide title: "Search delivered 70% of bookings at half the CPA of Meta", not "Results".
- **Big numbers, few words.** Body text at least 18 points; no paragraphs.
- **One chart per slide**, with the important bar or line highlighted in your accent colour and the rest in grey.
- **Consistent design:** one Canva or Slides template, the business colours, two fonts maximum.
- **Label every simulation** on the slide itself: "Forecast, not live results".
- **Anonymise:** crop or blur names, phone numbers and emails in every screenshot.

SECTION 19

Storytelling, rehearsal, Q&A

A good presentation is a story with data, not data with a story missing. This section covers the narrative, how to practise, how to handle questions, and how to present limited or simulated results honestly.



The story arc

Use a simple arc: **situation** (the business and its goal), **complication** (the problem or opportunity), **resolution** (your plan and what happened), **next step** (the decision you want). Put the answer first: senior audiences want the conclusion in the first minute (slide 2), then the evidence.

Weak	Strong
"Here are the numbers from Meta."	"Meta brought conversations cheaply, but they did not turn into bookings. Here is why."
"CTR was 1.8%."	"1.8% CTR, double our last campaign, so the resident-price message works."
"We could maybe try TikTok."	"Next: move Rs 4,000 from Meta to Search, and test one TikTok Spark Ad at Rs 3,000."

Rehearsal plan

1. **Write speaker notes** with 2–3 key points per slide, not a full script.
2. **Rehearse aloud with a timer**, twice at least. If you go over 20 minutes, cut slides, not your speed.
3. **Record one rehearsal** (phone, Google Meet or Zoom). Watch it once; note filler words, slides you rushed, slides nobody needs. This recording can also be your Exercise 20.3 submission if the session itself is not recorded.
4. **Present to a friend** who does not know marketing. If they cannot say what you recommended, simplify.
5. **Check the tech:** export a PDF backup, test screen sharing, close notifications, bring a charger.

Handling Q&A

Likely question	How to answer
"Why did you not use TikTok / LinkedIn / SEO?"	Give the reason linked to the objective and budget; say when you would add it.
"How do you know the ads caused the bookings?"	Explain your tracking and attribution, admit limits, suggest a holdout or lift test (Week 12).
"What would you do with double the budget?"	Point to diminishing returns; say which channel scales first and what you would watch.
"Is this number real?"	Say exactly where it comes from: live data, platform estimate or your forecast.
A question you cannot answer	"I do not know yet. I would check it in GA4 by… and I can send the answer after the session." Never invent.

Live, limited or simulated results: presenting them ethically

Situation	What you may show	How to label it
Live campaign, enough data	Real results, with dates and sources	"Live results, 3–21 June 2026, GA4 and Ads Manager"
Live but short or small budget	Real results plus a projection for a full month	"Live (14 days) + projection; small sample, treat with caution"
No live budget	A forecast from platform tools (Keyword Planner, Meta reach estimates) and benchmarks you cite	"Simulation: forecast based on these assumptions…"
Confidential numbers	Indexed values, percentages, ratios	"Indexed: May = 100" or "shown as % at the owner's request"

A forecast must show its **assumptions** (CPC, CTR, conversion rate, average order value, budget) and ideally **three scenarios**: cautious, expected and optimistic. Never present a simulation as real results, never copy another business's numbers as your own, and never edit a screenshot to change a figure.

PART D

Certification & Next Steps

How your final grade is calculated,
your competency self-assessment
and building your career from here

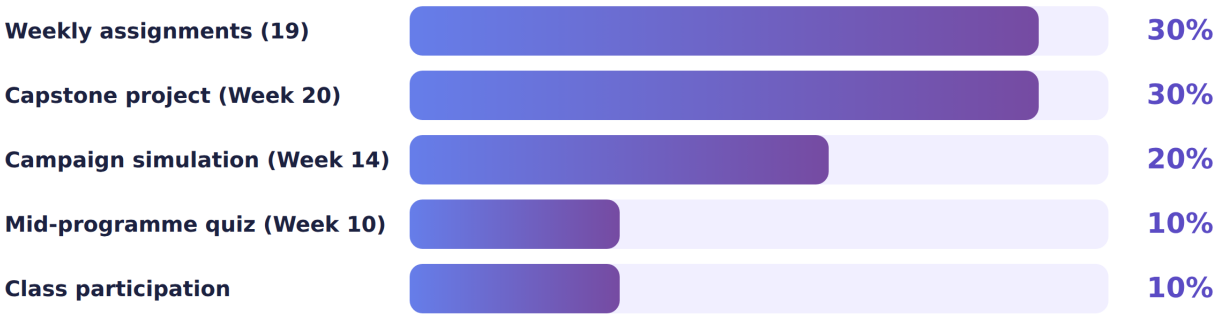
SECTION 20

How your grade is calculated

The DMM & AI Certificate is based on your work across the whole programme, not only on the capstone. Five components make up your final grade.

How your final grade is built

Five components, 100% in total



Weekly assignments and the capstone together make up 60% of the final grade.

Component	Weight	What it covers
Weekly assignments (19)	30%	The exercises and deliverables of Weeks 1–19
Mid-programme quiz (Week 10)	10%	Knowledge check on Phases 1 and 2
Campaign simulation (Week 14)	20%	Your simulated campaign work in Phase 3
Capstone project (Week 20)	30%	The six deliverables and the Full Strategy Presentation
Class participation	10%	Attendance, contributions, helping others, feedback
Total	**100%**	

Worked example

A student scores an average of 78% on the weekly assignments, 70% in the mid-programme quiz, 82% in the campaign simulation, 85% in the capstone and 90% for participation. Each score is multiplied by its weight:

Component	Score	Weight	Points
Weekly assignments	78%	× 0.30	23.4
Mid-programme quiz	70%	× 0.10	7.0
Campaign simulation	82%	× 0.20	16.4
Capstone project	85%	× 0.30	25.5
Class participation	90%	× 0.10	9.0
Final grade			**81.3%**

Formula: final grade = 0.30 × assignments + 0.10 × quiz + 0.20 × simulation + 0.30 × capstone + 0.10 × participation. The pass mark is confirmed by your trainers.

> **Tip:** a missing weekly assignment counts as 0 in the average and pulls down 30% of your grade. Submitting every assignment, even imperfect, is the easiest way to protect your grade.

Competency self-assessment

Before you present, rate yourself honestly from 1 (Beginning) to 4 (Advanced) using the rubric in Section 6. Ask a classmate to rate you too. The gaps show you what to improve before the panel, and what to learn after the programme.

Competency	Me (1–4)	Peer (1–4)	My evidence	One action to improve
Strategic Thinking				
Channel Execution				
Data & Analytics				
AI & Automation				
Communication				
Commercial Acumen				

SECTION 21

Portfolio, LinkedIn and next steps

The certificate opens doors; your portfolio gets you through them. Package your capstone so that an employer or client can understand it in two minutes, then keep learning.

Package your capstone as a case study

Part	Content
Title	"How a family guesthouse filled weekday rooms in the low season"
Challenge	The business goal and the problem, in 2–3 sentences
Approach	Audience, channels, budget, tracking, AI: 5 bullets
Results	3 numbers with context (or a labelled forecast)
What I learned	1–2 honest lessons; what I would do next
Visuals	2–3 images: an ad, the dashboard, a chart (anonymised)

Always ask the business before you publish anything about it, even anonymised. Keep confidential numbers out of a public portfolio; use percentages or indexed values.

LinkedIn (from Week 19)

- **Headline:** what you do and for whom, e.g. "Digital marketer | Google Ads, Meta Ads, GA4 | Helping Mauritian SMEs grow with data and AI".
- **Licenses & certifications:** add the DMM & AI Certificate and every platform certification you earn.
- **Featured:** add your capstone case study (PDF or link) and your best post.
- **Post about the journey:** one post on what you built and learned, with permission from the business. Tag the training provider and thank your classmates.
- **Skills:** list the tools you actually used in the capstone.

Continuing education: free certifications

Names and programmes change; check the official sites before you start.

Provider	What is available	Cost
Google Skillshop	Google Ads certifications (for example Search, Display, Video, Shopping, Apps, Measurement and AI-Powered Performance Ads) and the Google Analytics certification. Valid for one year, then retake.	Free
Meta Blueprint	Free self-paced courses on Facebook, Instagram and WhatsApp advertising. The official Meta Certified exams (for example Digital Marketing Associate) are paid and booked separately; the price varies by country.	Courses free; exams paid
HubSpot Academy	Free courses with certificates, for example Inbound Marketing, Content Marketing, Email Marketing, Digital Marketing and SEO.	Free
Google Search Central, Think with Google	Official documentation and research on search and marketing (no certificate)	Free

Stay connected

- **Alumni network:** stay in the programme's alumni group. Share job leads, ask questions, find partners for freelance projects, and come back as a guest to show later cohorts what you built.
- **Keep a learning routine:** 30 minutes a week reading platform updates (Google Ads, Meta, GA4 release notes).
- **Practise for real:** offer a small, paid or volunteer project to a local SME or NGO every quarter. Each one becomes a new case study.
- **Plan your next step:** in-house role, agency, freelance, or growing your own business. Your Week 19 personal brand strategy is your roadmap.

PART E

Whole-Course Revision

One-page summaries of Weeks 1–19
and the formula sheet you will
use for the rest of your career

The 20-week programme at a glance

Four phases. The capstone uses something from every week

PHASE 1
Digital Foundations
Weeks 1–4
Ecosystem · Websites & analytics · SEO · Content

PHASE 2
Core Channels & Paid Media
Weeks 5–10
Social · Google Ads x2 · Meta Ads · Display & video · Email & CRM

PHASE 3
Advanced Performance & AI
Weeks 11–16
Analytics · ROAS · AI x2 · Automation · E-commerce

PHASE 4
Strategy & Leadership
Weeks 17–20
Strategy · Reporting · Personal brand · Capstone

SECTION 22

Revision: Weeks 1–5

Phase 1 (Digital Foundations) and the start of Phase 2. These weeks give you the vocabulary and the foundations that every later week builds on.

Week 1 · The Digital Marketing Ecosystem

Big idea	Marketing starts from business objectives; digital adds measurability and reach. Every channel is part of one ecosystem around your website and data.
Key concepts	Consumer journey (awareness → consideration → conversion → loyalty → advocacy); paid, owned and earned media; channels and tools; SMART objectives; KPIs vs metrics; the Mauritius digital landscape (mobile-first, Facebook, WhatsApp and Instagram widely used).
Numbers and formulas	CTR = clicks ÷ impressions × 100 · CPC = spend ÷ clicks · CVR = conversions ÷ clicks × 100 · CPA = spend ÷ conversions · ROAS = revenue ÷ ad spend · LTV = average order × purchase frequency × customer lifespan.
Tools	Google Trends, DataReportal, Meta Ad Library.
Deliverable	Audit Report of a business's digital presence.

Week 2 · Website & Analytics Foundations

Big idea	The website is the hub every channel sends people to. If you cannot measure it, you cannot improve it.
Key concepts	Website types, domain/DNS/hosting/CMS; UX, page speed and mobile-first; conversion path; GA4 events and **key events** (formerly conversions); users, sessions, engagement rate; funnels; attribution (GA4 default: data-driven); GTM tags, triggers, variables; UTMs; Data Studio dashboards.
Numbers and formulas	Core Web Vitals "good": LCP 2.5 s or less, INP 200 ms or less, CLS 0.1 or less. Engaged session: 10+ seconds, 2+ page views or a key event. Engagement rate = engaged sessions ÷ sessions.
Tools	GA4, Google Tag Manager, Data Studio, PageSpeed Insights, Tag Assistant.
Deliverable	Dashboard (website and analytics setup with a Data Studio report).

Week 3 · SEO Fundamentals

Big idea	Be found when people search, on Google and in AI answers. SEO is slow but compounding and free per click.
Key concepts	How Google crawls, indexes and ranks; search intent; keyword research and long-tail; on-page SEO (title, meta description, headings, internal links, images); technical SEO (robots.txt, sitemaps, 301 redirects, speed); E-E-A-T; local SEO and Google Business Profile (NAP consistency: the same Name, Address and Phone everywhere online; reviews); AEO (answer engines) and GEO (generative engines).
Numbers and formulas	Search Console: impressions, clicks, CTR, average position. Organic CTR = clicks ÷ impressions.
Tools	Google Search Console, Keyword Planner, Google Trends, Google Business Profile.
Deliverable	SEO Action Plan.

Week 4 · Content Marketing & Strategy

Big idea	Useful, consistent content earns attention and trust that ads alone cannot buy.
Key concepts	Content across the journey; audience personas; content and competitor audit; positioning and tone of voice; content pillars (3–5 recurring themes all content is built around); formats and the content mix; storytelling and copywriting; Canva visuals; short-form video; repurposing; editorial calendar; distribution; using AI responsibly.
Numbers and formulas	KPIs by goal: reach and views (awareness), engagement rate and saves (consideration), clicks and leads (conversion).
Tools	Canva, CapCut, Meta Business Suite, Google Trends, AnswerThePublic.
Deliverable	Content Strategy Document with sample pieces.

Week 5 · Social Media Marketing

Big idea	Each platform has its own algorithm, audience and format. Organic social builds community; paid social scales it.
Key concepts	How algorithms rank content (relevance, engagement, recency); choosing platforms; social audit and benchmarking; profile optimisation; Facebook, Instagram, TikTok, LinkedIn, YouTube, WhatsApp Business; community management, customer service and crisis handling; creators and UGC; scheduling; analytics and the monthly report.
Numbers and formulas	Engagement rate by reach = (reactions + comments + shares + saves) ÷ reach × 100.
Tools	Meta Business Suite, TikTok, LinkedIn, WhatsApp Business, Buffer or Hootsuite.
Deliverable	Social Playbook.

SECTION 23

Revision: Weeks 6–10

Phase 2: the core paid and owned channels. These weeks give you the hands-on skills employers test in interviews.

Week 6 · Google Ads: Search Fundamentals

Big idea	Search ads catch people at the moment they are looking. You pay per click; the auction rewards relevance, not only money.
Key concepts	Auction and Ad Rank; Quality Score basics; account structure (account → campaign → ad group → keywords and ads); conversion tracking; networks, locations ("presence"), languages; Keyword Planner; match types (broad; phrase; exact = searches with the same meaning as the keyword); negative keywords; responsive search ads (up to 15 headlines, 4 descriptions); assets; bidding strategies; Performance Max and AI Max.
Numbers and formulas	Daily budget ≈ monthly budget ÷ 30.4. Clicks per day ≈ daily budget ÷ CPC.
Tools	Google Ads, Keyword Planner, Ads Transparency Center.
Deliverable	Campaign Blueprint.

Week 7 · Google Ads: Advanced Search & Optimisation

Big idea	Launching is easy; optimising is the job. Improve relevance, cut waste, feed the bidding with good data.
Key concepts	Quality Score (1–10) from expected CTR, ad relevance and landing page experience; search terms report and negatives; ad strength and asset performance; audiences in Search and remarketing; Smart Bidding (tCPA, tROAS); budgets, pacing and impression share; experiments; recommendations; account audit.
Numbers and formulas	Break-even CPA = average order value × margin. Impression share = impressions ÷ eligible impressions.
Tools	Google Ads (experiments, auction insights), GA4, Data Studio.
Deliverable	Performance Audit of a Google Ads account.

Week 8 · Meta Ads: Facebook & Instagram

Big idea	Meta finds the people; your creative persuades them. Give the algorithm a clear objective, good signals and strong creative.
Key concepts	Business portfolio and ad account; objectives (Awareness, Traffic, Engagement, Leads, App promotion, Sales); campaign → ad set → ad; Pixel and Conversions API; Advantage+ audience and placements; custom and lookalike audiences; click-to-WhatsApp and lead ads; creative that performs; learning phase; A/B tests; attribution settings.
Numbers and formulas	Learning phase: about 50 optimisation events in 7 days per ad set. CPM = cost ÷ impressions × 1,000. Frequency = impressions ÷ reach.
Tools	Meta Ads Manager, Events Manager, Ad Library.
Deliverable	Meta Launch Plan.

Week 9 · Display, Video & Programmatic

Big idea	Awareness advertising builds the memory that makes later searches and sales happen.
Key concepts	Display Network, Demand Gen, YouTube formats and campaign types; audience and contextual targeting; reach and frequency planning; ABCD creative (Attract, Brand, Connect, Direct); programmatic (DSPs, SSPs, exchanges); CTV, digital out-of-home, retail media; brand lift; viewability, invalid traffic and brand safety.
Numbers and formulas	Impressions = reach × frequency. CPV = cost ÷ views. Viewable display impression: at least 50% of pixels on screen for 1 second (video: 2 seconds).
Tools	Google Ads (Display, Demand Gen, YouTube), YouTube Studio.
Deliverable	Awareness Campaign plan.

Week 10 · Email Marketing & CRM

Big idea	Your list is an audience you own. Consent first, then relevance, then automation.
Key concepts	Consent and the Data Protection Act 2017; list building and lead magnets; email types and calendar; subject lines and preheaders; design for mobile; SPF, DKIM and DMARC; inbox rules and list hygiene; segmentation and RFM; automation sequences; WhatsApp and SMS; CRM basics and HubSpot free CRM; lead scoring; A/B tests.
Numbers and formulas	Open rate = unique opens ÷ delivered. Click rate = unique clicks ÷ delivered. Click-to-open = unique clicks ÷ unique opens. Unsubscribe rate = unsubscribes ÷ delivered. Keep spam complaints below 0.1%.
Tools	Mailchimp, Brevo, MailerLite, HubSpot free CRM, WhatsApp Business.
Deliverable	Email Strategy with a 5-email sequence.

SECTION 24

Revision: Weeks 11–15

Phase 3: advanced performance and AI. These weeks turn a channel operator into a marketer who can prove and scale results.

Week 11 · Advanced Analytics & Data

Big idea	Ask a business question first, then find the data. Know where every number comes from.
Key concepts	GA4 data model and scopes (user, session, event, item); measurement plan; dataLayer and custom events in GTM; recommended events; custom dimensions; consent; explorations (free form, funnel, path, segment overlap, cohort); audiences; channel groups; attribution models and their limits; BigQuery link; Data Studio blends, controls and parameters; data quality audit; why numbers differ between tools.
Numbers and formulas	Funnel step rate = users completing step ÷ users at previous step. Abandonment = 1 − step rate.
Tools	GA4 explorations, GTM, Data Studio, Search Console, BigQuery.
Deliverable	Analytics Report.

Week 12 · Performance Marketing & ROAS

Big idea	Every rupee accountable: optimise for profit, not clicks, and test what is truly incremental.
Key concepts	Unit economics; ROAS, ROI, POAS and MER; break-even and target ROAS; attribution vs incrementality; holdout and lift tests; tracking audit; enhanced conversions, Conversions API, offline and WhatsApp leads; value-based bidding (tROAS, value rules); diminishing returns; 70/20/10; seasonality; scaling rules; forecasting with scenarios.
Numbers and formulas	Break-even ROAS = 1 ÷ contribution margin. Max CPA = AOV × contribution margin. POAS = contribution ÷ ad spend. MER = total revenue ÷ total marketing spend. nCAC = marketing spend ÷ new customers. LTV:CAC = LTV ÷ CAC.
Tools	Google Ads, Meta Ads Manager, GA4, a forecasting spreadsheet.
Deliverable	Performance Audit with budget recommendations.

Week 13 · AI in Digital Marketing, Part 1: Content Creation

Big idea	AI is a fast, tireless assistant that needs a clear brief and a human editor.
Key concepts	Layers of AI (AI → machine learning → deep learning → generative AI); how language models work; hallucinations and bias; ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini; free vs paid and privacy; the C.A.R.E. framework (Context, Action, Result, Example); prompting techniques and iteration; brand voice brief; prompt library; AI for research, SEO, social, email, ads, translation and data analysis; quality control; copyright, data protection, disclosure.
Numbers and formulas	Measure AI value as time saved × hourly cost, plus quality checks passed.
Tools	ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Canva AI.
Deliverable	AI Prompt Toolkit.

Week 14 · AI in Digital Marketing, Part 2: Paid Media & Automation

Big idea	You steer, AI scales: give ad-platform AI good inputs and automate the repetitive work safely.
Key concepts	Image and video generation (diffusion); brand consistency; rights and AI labels (C2PA content credentials record a file's origin and whether AI created or edited it); Midjourney, ChatGPT, Gemini, Firefly, Canva; AI video for ads; Zapier and Make; Google Ads AI (Smart Bidding, Performance Max, AI Max, Asset Studio); Meta Advantage+ and generative AI; TikTok Symphony; AI agents; governance of data, keys and costs.
Numbers and formulas	ROI of AI = (value of time saved + extra profit − AI costs) ÷ AI costs.
Tools	Midjourney, Firefly, Canva, Zapier, Make, Google Ads, Meta Ads Manager.
Deliverable	AI Integration Plan (and the Week 14 campaign simulation, 20% of the grade).

Week 15 · Marketing Automation & Lead Nurturing

Big idea	Leads that never go cold: capture, score, nurture and hand over automatically, with people doing the conversations.
Key concepts	Lead lifecycle (subscriber, lead, MQL = good fit and enough interest to pass to sales, SQL, opportunity, customer, advocate); building blocks (trigger, action, condition, delay, branch); journey mapping; forms, lead ads, DMs and chatbots; lead scoring (fit + engagement, decay); nurture by stage; behaviour triggers; Zapier vs Make vs native; ManyChat; WhatsApp opt-in; HubSpot pipelines and tasks; sales handoff and SLAs; testing; compliance.
Numbers and formulas	Lead-to-customer rate = customers ÷ leads. Speed to lead = time from enquiry to first reply.
Tools	HubSpot, Zapier, Make, ManyChat, WhatsApp Business.
Deliverable	Automation System.

SECTION 25

Revision: Weeks 16–19

The end of Phase 3 and Phase 4 (Strategy & Leadership). These weeks bring everything together into strategy, reporting and your career.

Week 16 · E-Commerce & Advanced Conversion

Big idea	More traffic is not always the answer: improve conversion, order value and repeat purchases first.
Key concepts	Online store platforms; product pages, cart and checkout; trust and payment options; product feeds and shopping ads; CRO process (research, hypothesis, test, learn); A/B testing; cart and browse abandonment flows; cross-sell, upsell and bundles; retention and loyalty.
Numbers and formulas	E-commerce CVR = orders ÷ sessions × 100. AOV = revenue ÷ orders. Revenue per session = CVR × AOV. Cart abandonment = 1 − purchases ÷ carts created (often around 70%). Repeat purchase rate = repeat customers ÷ all customers.
Tools	Shopify or WooCommerce, Google Merchant Center, GA4 e-commerce reports.
Deliverable	E-Commerce Growth Plan.

Week 17 · Digital Marketing Strategy

Big idea	Strategy is choosing what not to do. Link every marketing action to a business goal over 12 months.
Key concepts	Situation analysis (PESTLE, SWOT, competitor analysis); a planning framework such as SOSTAC (Situation, Objectives, Strategy, Tactics, Action, Control); segmentation, targeting and positioning; objectives cascade; channel mix and budget allocation; 12-month roadmap and quarterly priorities; risks; governance.
Numbers and formulas	Marketing budget often planned as a share of revenue; channel budgets from targets (clicks needed × CPC).
Tools	Google Docs or Slides, Google Trends, Statistics Mauritius, AI for research.
Deliverable	12-Month Strategy Document.

Week 18 · Performance Reporting & Data Storytelling

Big idea	A report is for decisions. Lead with the answer, show the evidence, recommend the next step.
Key concepts	Report types (weekly, monthly, quarterly); audience-first reporting (owner vs specialist); KPI hierarchy; comparisons (vs target, vs previous period, vs last year); choosing the right chart; highlighting; insights (what, so what, now what); executive summary; dashboards vs reports; automating data with Data Studio.
Numbers and formulas	Change % = (this period − last period) ÷ last period × 100. Percentage points for differences between rates.
Tools	Data Studio, Google Sheets, Google Slides or PowerPoint, Canva.
Deliverable	Quarterly Report.

Week 19 · Personal Branding & Career Acceleration

Big idea	People hire people they know and trust. Show your work, consistently, where decision-makers look.
Key concepts	Personal brand positioning; LinkedIn profile (headline, About, Featured, experience, licenses and certifications); content plan for thought leadership; networking; portfolio and case studies; CV and interviews; career paths (in-house, agency, freelance, consulting); pricing freelance work.
Numbers and formulas	Simple day rate check: target annual income ÷ billable days.
Tools	LinkedIn, Canva, a portfolio page or PDF.
Deliverable	Personal Brand Strategy.

SECTION 26

Formula sheet

Every formula of the programme in one place, with standard definitions. Percentages are multiplied by 100; ratios such as ROAS can be written as 4.0 or 400%.



> **Tip:** rates are compared in **percentage points**: a conversion rate that rises from 2% to 3% has risen by 1 percentage point, which is a 50% increase.

Advertising formulas

The examples follow the same fictional campaign as the chart above: Rs 20,000 spent, 100,000 impressions, 1,500 clicks, 45 orders at Rs 1,800.

Metric	Formula	Example
CTR (click-through rate)	Clicks ÷ impressions × 100	1,500 ÷ 100,000 = 1.5%
CPC (cost per click)	Cost ÷ clicks	Rs 20,000 ÷ 1,500 = Rs 13.33
CPM (cost per 1,000 impressions)	Cost ÷ impressions × 1,000	Rs 20,000 ÷ 100,000 × 1,000 = Rs 200
CVR (conversion rate)	Conversions ÷ clicks (or sessions) × 100	45 ÷ 1,500 = 3%
CPA / CPL (cost per acquisition / lead)	Cost ÷ conversions	Rs 20,000 ÷ 45 = Rs 444
ROAS (return on ad spend)	Revenue from ads ÷ ad spend	Rs 81,000 ÷ Rs 20,000 = 4.05
Reach and frequency	Frequency = impressions ÷ reach	100,000 ÷ 40,000 = 2.5
CPV (cost per view)	Cost ÷ views	Rs 6,000 ÷ 15,000 = Rs 0.40
Impression share	Impressions ÷ eligible impressions × 100	8,000 ÷ 20,000 = 40%

Profit formulas

Use the contribution margin (after all variable costs) whenever you can; gross margin alone makes ads look more profitable than they are.

Metric	Formula	Example
Gross / contribution margin	(Price − variable costs) ÷ price	(Rs 1,800 − Rs 1,080) ÷ Rs 1,800 = 40%
Break-even ROAS	1 ÷ margin	1 ÷ 0.40 = 2.5
Target ROAS with a profit goal	1 ÷ (margin − profit goal as % of revenue)	1 ÷ (0.40 − 0.15) = 4.0
Break-even (maximum) CPA	AOV × margin	Rs 1,800 × 0.40 = Rs 720
POAS (profit on ad spend)	Contribution ÷ ad spend	Rs 32,400 ÷ Rs 20,000 = 1.62
ROI	(Gain − cost) ÷ cost × 100	(Rs 32,400 − Rs 20,000) ÷ Rs 20,000 = 62%
MER (marketing efficiency ratio)	Total revenue ÷ total marketing spend	Rs 600,000 ÷ Rs 60,000 = 10
CAC (customer acquisition cost)	Marketing spend ÷ new customers	Rs 60,000 ÷ 120 = Rs 500

Customer and e-commerce formulas

These formulas describe the value of customers over time, not only the first order.

Metric	Formula	Example
AOV (average order value)	Revenue ÷ orders	Rs 81,000 ÷ 45 = Rs 1,800
LTV (simple, revenue)	AOV × purchases per year × years as a customer	Rs 1,800 × 3 × 2 = Rs 10,800
LTV (profit)	Revenue LTV × margin	Rs 10,800 × 0.40 = Rs 4,320
LTV:CAC	LTV (profit) ÷ CAC	Rs 4,320 ÷ Rs 500 = 8.6
Cart abandonment rate	1 − (purchases ÷ carts created)	1 − (45 ÷ 150) = 70%

Metric	Formula	Example
Revenue per session	Revenue ÷ sessions (= CVR × AOV)	Rs 81,000 ÷ 3,000 = Rs 27
Repeat purchase rate	Customers with 2+ orders ÷ all customers × 100	60 ÷ 400 = 15%

Social, email and website formulas

Always say which denominator you used (reach, followers, delivered, opens), because different tools use different ones.

Metric	Formula	Example
Engagement rate (social, by reach)	(Reactions + comments + shares + saves) ÷ reach × 100	240 ÷ 6,000 = 4%
Engagement rate (GA4)	Engaged sessions ÷ sessions × 100	1,800 ÷ 3,000 = 60%
Email open rate	Unique opens ÷ delivered × 100	880 ÷ 1,960 = 44.9%
Email click rate	Unique clicks ÷ delivered × 100	98 ÷ 1,960 = 5%
Click-to-open rate	Unique clicks ÷ unique opens × 100	98 ÷ 880 = 11.1%
Bounce rate (email)	Bounced ÷ sent × 100	40 ÷ 2,000 = 2%
Unsubscribe rate	Unsubscribes ÷ delivered × 100	8 ÷ 1,960 = 0.41%
Lead-to-customer rate	Customers ÷ leads × 100	18 ÷ 120 = 15%
Change vs previous period	(New − old) ÷ old × 100	(58 − 37) ÷ 37 = +56.8%

PART F

Put It to Work

A complete capstone case study,
FAQ, exercises, templates,
glossary and final checklists

SECTION 27

Case study: a full capstone

A fictional example that shows what a strong capstone looks like from start to finish. The business, the people and the numbers are illustrative.

The business

Zanana Bijoux is a small handmade jewellery brand in Curepipe. It sells through an online store, Instagram, WhatsApp and a weekend market stall. Average order value is about Rs 1,800 and the contribution margin (after materials, packaging, payment fees and delivery) is 40%. The owner wants more online orders without relying on the market stall. The student works part-time for the brand and has written permission from the owner.

Analysis and objective

Element	What the student found or decided
Key insight	Most Instagram DMs ask "how much?" and "do you deliver to …?". Prices and delivery fees are hard to find on the site.
SWOT headline	Strength: unique designs and 4.9-star reviews. Weakness: slow mobile site, no key events. Opportunity: gift demand before Mother's Day in May. Threat: cheap imported jewellery on social media.
SMART objective	45 online orders in the 3 weeks before Mother's Day, at a CPA under Rs 720 (break-even = Rs 1,800 × 0.40).
Persona	"Gift-buyer Anjali": 25–40, works in Ebène or Port Louis, buys gifts for her mother and friends, shops on her phone in the evening.
Positioning	Handmade in Mauritius, gift-ready in a box, delivered island-wide in 48 hours.

Plan and build

- **Budget:** Rs 20,000 approved: Meta Rs 12,000, Google Search Rs 6,000, creative and tools Rs 2,000. Email and WhatsApp broadcasts to opted-in customers at no media cost.
- **Meta:** one Sales campaign, Advantage+ audience and a single ad set (two would split a small budget too thinly) with 6 ads: 3 Reels (price-led, gift-box unboxing, maker at work) and 3 carousels.
- **Google Search:** brand and "gift for mum Mauritius" ad groups, phrase and exact match, sitelinks for Necklaces, Earrings and Delivery.
- **Tracking:** GA4 e-commerce events (view_item, add_to_cart, begin_checkout, purchase with value), Meta Pixel plus the store's Conversions API integration, UTM convention, test log.
- **AI:** captions in EN and FR drafted with C.A.R.E. prompts and edited; Canva AI to resize 1:1 to 9:16; a Make scenario that copies each new order to a Google Sheet and emails the owner a daily summary.

Results (3 weeks, live)

The campaign ran for three weeks with tracking tested before launch. Orders come from the store; clicks and spend come from the ad platforms.

Channel	Spend	Clicks	Orders	Revenue	CPA	ROAS
Meta (FB + IG)	Rs 12,000	1,440	24	Rs 44,400	Rs 500	3.70
Google Search	Rs 6,000	400	14	Rs 26,600	Rs 429	4.43

Channel	Spend	Clicks	Orders	Revenue	CPA	ROAS
Email + WhatsApp	Rs 0	310	9	Rs 15,300	-	-
Total	**Rs 18,000** media	**2,150**	**47**	**Rs 86,300**	**Rs 383**	**4.79**

Fictional numbers from the store and platform reports. Total CPA and ROAS include owned-channel orders; paid-only ROAS = Rs 71,000 ÷ Rs 18,000 = 3.94. Adding Rs 2,000 creative and tools, MER = Rs 86,300 ÷ Rs 20,000 = 4.3.

Insights the student presented

What	So what	Now what
Price-led Reels had a CTR of 2.1% vs 1.1% for lifestyle Reels	Showing the price early removes the main objection seen in DMs	Put the price in the first 2 seconds of every Reel
Only 31% of checkouts were completed (47 of 150)	Delivery fee appears only at the last step; the funnel exploration shows the drop there	Show delivery fees on product pages; test free delivery above Rs 2,500
Search had the lowest paid CPA (Rs 429)	High intent: people already looking for a gift	Move Rs 3,000 from Meta to Search for Father's Day; add a "gift for dad" ad group
Contribution Rs 34,520 vs total cost Rs 20,000	The campaign made about Rs 14,500 profit, before counting repeat purchases	Recommend a monthly budget of Rs 20,000 with the changes above

Why this capstone scores well: a clear objective with break-even maths; tracking tested before launch; honest about the weak checkout; every chart has a message; AI used and checked; recommendations with expected impact and a budget. What would make it "Advanced": a holdout test for the email list, a sensitivity table for the next quarter and LTV based on repeat customers.

SECTION 28

Capstone FAQ

The questions students ask most often.

Can I use a fictional business?

No. The brief asks for a real Mauritian business. If you have no access to one, ask your trainers to help you find an SME or NGO; you may anonymise its name.

The owner will not give me any budget. Can I still pass?

Yes. Build everything to launch-ready, then present a clearly labelled simulation with assumptions and three scenarios (Section 19). Organic actions (Google Business Profile, posts, email to opted-in contacts) can still give you some live data.

Can I reuse my weekly assignments?

Yes, and you should, but update and connect them. The panel wants one coherent campaign, not separate pieces.

How long should the strategy document be?

About 8–12 pages plus appendices. Clarity beats length.

Do I need Google Ads and Meta Ads?

You need the channels that fit the objective. Most capstones use at least one of them; if you use neither, explain why convincingly.

Can I work with a classmate?

The capstone is individual. You may help each other with feedback and rehearsals; each person submits their own business and work.

Can I use AI to write my deck?

You may use AI to draft, structure and check, as in any professional job. Say where you used it, check every fact, and make sure you can explain every slide yourself.

My results are bad. Will I fail?

Not because of bad results. You are assessed on the quality of your thinking, execution, measurement and honesty. A well-explained failure with clear lessons can score higher than unexplained success.

What if my tracking broke halfway?

Say so. Show what you found, how you fixed it, and use platform data or a careful estimate for the missing period, clearly labelled.

Can I present in French or Kreol?

The programme is taught in English with French and Kreol support. Present in English unless your trainers agree otherwise; ads and examples can be in the language the customers use.

What is the pass mark?

The pass mark for the certificate is confirmed by your trainers. Section 20 shows how the final grade is calculated.

SECTION 29

Exercises and templates

The capstone is submitted in three steps on the learning platform. The last one is the Full Strategy Presentation.

Exercise	What to submit	When
20.1 Capstone proposal	One-page proposal (template below): business, written permission (screenshot, personal details hidden), access, business goal, SMART objective, audience, likely channels, budget (real or simulated), risks and ethics. Link to a Google Doc.	Week 1 of the plan
20.2 Mid-point review: tracking and dashboard	Strategy document draft (Sections 8–12), tracking plan with test log (Section 14), dashboard link, campaign build screenshots or simulation set-up, and 3 questions for your trainers.	Week 3 of the plan
20.3 Full Strategy Presentation (deliverable)	The 12–15 slide deck (Section 18), the recording of your presentation or rehearsal, and the folder with all six deliverables (Section 5).	Week 4 (Week 20)

Template 1: capstone proposal (one page)

Field	Your answer
Business name (or anonymised description), sector, town	
Permission: who agreed, how, date	
Access I have (website, GA4, ad accounts, social, sales data)	
Business goal for this year	
SMART marketing objective	
Main audience	
Likely channels and why	
Budget: real (amount, approved by) or simulated	
Risks (access, policy, seasonality, confidentiality) and how I will handle them	

Template 2: forecast assumptions (for simulations)

Assumption	Cautious	Expected	Optimistic	Source
Budget	Rs 20,000	Rs 20,000	Rs 20,000	Owner plan
CPC	Rs 18	Rs 14	Rs 11	Keyword Planner, Week 6–8 benchmarks
Clicks	1,111	1,429	1,818	Budget ÷ CPC
Conversion rate	1.5%	2.5%	3.5%	GA4 history
Orders	17	36	64	Clicks × CVR
AOV	Rs 1,700	Rs 1,800	Rs 1,900	Store data
Revenue / ROAS	Rs 28,900 / 1.4	Rs 64,800 / 3.2	Rs 121,600 / 6.1	Orders × AOV; ÷ budget

Clicks and orders rounded to whole numbers. Compare each ROAS with break-even (2.5 at a 40% margin): only the expected and optimistic scenarios are profitable.

Template 3: mid-point review questions

- ☐ Does my objective still match the business goal and my access?
- ☐ Is every key event tested, with the result in my log?
- ☐ Does my dashboard show the north-star KPI, its trend and the split by channel?
- ☐ Is anything off-track? What will I change this week?
- ☐ What are my 3 questions for the trainers?

SECTION 30

Glossary and final checklists

Key terms from across the programme, then the three checklists to use before you submit, before you present, and after the programme.

Term	Meaning
AEO / GEO	Answer and Generative Engine Optimisation: being cited in AI answers and AI search results
Attribution	How credit for a conversion is shared between channels and touchpoints
AOV	Average order value: revenue ÷ orders
Break-even ROAS	The ROAS at which ads neither make nor lose money: 1 ÷ margin
Capstone	The final integrated project of the programme
CAPI (Conversions API)	Meta's server-side connection that sends events directly from a server or platform
Consent mode	Google setting that adjusts tags according to the visitor's cookie choice
CRO	Conversion rate optimisation: improving the share of visitors who act
Data Studio	Google's free dashboard tool (called Looker Studio until April 2026)
DPA 2017	Mauritius Data Protection Act 2017, the law on personal data
Executive summary	The problem, action, result and recommendation in a few lines, at the start
Forecast / simulation	Expected results based on stated assumptions, not live data; must be labelled
Incrementality	Results that would not have happened without the marketing
Key event	A GA4 event marked as important for the business (formerly "conversion")
KPI	Key performance indicator: a metric tied to an objective
LTV	Lifetime value: what a customer brings over the whole relationship
MER	Marketing efficiency ratio: total revenue ÷ total marketing spend
NDA	Non-disclosure agreement: a contract to keep information confidential
North-star KPI	The single KPI that best shows progress towards the objective
POAS	Profit on ad spend: contribution ÷ ad spend
Positioning statement	One sentence that says for whom, what benefit and why to believe it
Rubric	The grid of criteria and levels used to assess work
SMART	Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound
SOSTAC	Planning framework: Situation, Objectives, Strategy, Tactics, Action, Control
SWOT	Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, Threats
UTM parameters	Tags added to a link to tell analytics the source, medium and campaign

Before you submit

☐ Written permission saved; personal data removed or blurred everywhere
☐ All six deliverables in one folder with clear names (Section 5)
☐ Every number has a source; every simulation is labelled with its assumptions
☐ Break-even CPA or ROAS shown next to results

- ☐ Links open for the trainers (view access to Docs, Sheets, Data Studio, Canva)
- ☐ Spelling, prices, dates and names checked

Before you present

- ☐ Deck of 12–15 slides; each title is a message
- ☐ Rehearsed twice with a timer; under 20 minutes
- ☐ One recording made and watched
- ☐ PDF backup and screen-sharing tested
- ☐ Answers ready for the 5 likely questions (Section 19)
- ☐ Clear final ask and next 90 days

After the programme

- ☐ Capstone packaged as a portfolio case study, with the business's OK
- ☐ LinkedIn updated: headline, certificate, Featured case study
- ☐ One free platform certification booked (Skillshop, Blueprint or HubSpot Academy)
- ☐ Access to the business's accounts removed or handed over if asked
- ☐ Joined the alumni network; next project planned